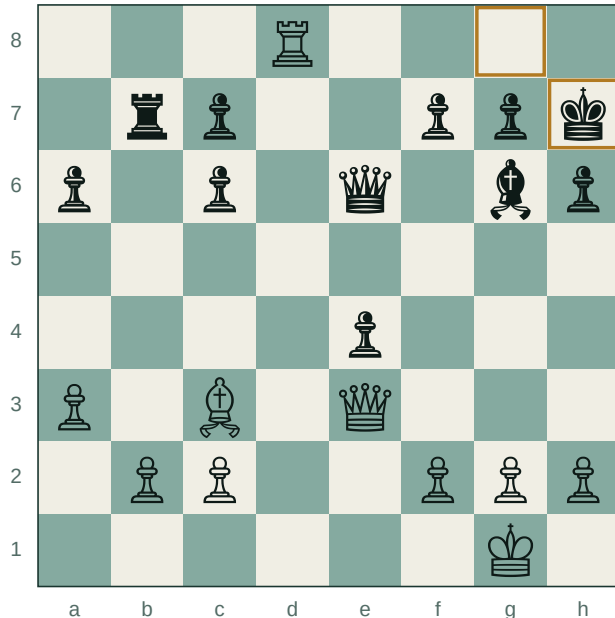


Attraction tactics: White, move 23

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 22...Kh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Rh8+ Kxh8 24. Qxh6+ Kg8 25. Qxg7#

23.Rh8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **23...Kxh8**.

24.Qxh6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From h6 it attacks king on h8 and bishop on g6. Recorded reply: **24...Kg8**.

25.Qxg7# Mate: queen on g7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: rook on b7. Check for tactical protection.